



Mangafont Comic

マンガフォント コミック

A Latin alphabet drawn in katakana, cut for comic lettering. Its capitals and its lowercase come from two different registers on purpose — brush above, slab below — and the katakana come with it, so ラーメン and RAMEN set in one face.

TITLE

TOKYO RONIN

SOUND FX

KRAKKK!

DIALOGUE

YOU SHOULDN'T HAVE COME HERE.

CAPTION

Later that night, it started to rain again.

KATAKANA
MANGAFONT COMIC

ラーメン ラーメン

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Everything below is set in Mangafont Comic — balloons, captions, sound effects and signage alike.

Rain again. It had been
raining for a week.

東

WHERE IS
HE?

I TOLD YOU. HE
DOESN'T COME HERE
ANY MORE.

フーッ

KRAKKK!

THEN I'LL
WAIT.

Balloon lettering is traditionally set in capitals, which is why the caps carry the more dramatic register. Captions and narration run in lowercase, where the slab forms keep their counters open at small sizes.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789 & @ # \$ %

.,/;!?"'()"[]{}<>/_|-~
^\'*+=

KATAKANA

ア イ ウ エ オ カ キ ク コ サ シ ス セ ソ タ チ ツ テ ト

ナニズネノハヒフヘホデミルモヤルヨテリ

ルレロワヲン並ニ 一ノ〇

VOICED AND SEMI-VOICED

オキヅイゴザジズビヅチヅ子ドバビブベホ

パピブペネ

SMALL

ア イ ウ エ オ カ キ ク ケ コ

The complete U+30A1-U+30F4 block. Foreign words need all of it: ブルー= needs ブ, and ティ, ギィ and ジェ need the small kana.

The capitals and the lowercase are drawn to different specifications. Caps come from a sumi-brush cut: high contrast, dramatic tapers, large terminal flags. Lowercase comes from a kanji-slab cut: near-monoline, heavy, counters held open.

This is ordinary type practice taken further than usual — caps are normally drawn a shade lighter than lowercase so the two colours match. The two registers sit together here because their stems were already close: **216** against **202**. Had they been far apart, the line would read as two fonts sharing it.

CAPS FROM

TOKYO RONIN

LOWER FROM

tokyo ronin

TOGETHER

Tokyo Ronin

SPECIFICATION

MEASURE	VALUE	REGISTER	STEM	HAIRLINE	CONTRAST
Units per em	1000	Capitals — brush	216	62	0.29
Cap height	790				
x-height	600 — 0.76 of cap				
Ascender / descender	858 / -170	Lowercase — slab	202	168	0.83
Weight class	800				

STROKE OVERSHOOT

Both registers let strokes run past their joins rather than stopping at them, by 10 units in the caps and 36 in the lowercase. A large part of why kanji read as kanji at a glance is that strokes cross and stick out; stopping every stroke politely at its junction is what makes a Latin face built on kanji logic look merely decorative.

Mangafont Comic covers Latin and katakana, not kanji. A character such as 東 falls back to whatever else is installed, as it does here and in the first panel overleaf.